GRADE 11 / Geography / English

Use development indicators critically

01 Understand

Learning goals: Calculate a per-person average • Compare economic and social indicators • Explain why averages hide inequality

Development involves changes in living conditions and opportunities, not only economic output.

GDP per capita divides output by population. It is an average and does not describe how income is distributed.

Use several indicators, such as life expectancy, education and access to services. Compare the same year, units and methods before drawing conclusions.

Invented data for comparison practice

Indicator	Place A	Place B
GDP per capita	R100 000	R80 000
Life expectancy	62 years	72 years
Access to safe water	70%	95%

02 Follow the reasoning

Can you conclude that A is more developed simply because its GDP per capita is higher?

1. A has the higher measured average output per person.

2. B has higher life expectancy and water access in this invented dataset.

3. A single indicator cannot justify the full conclusion. Assess distribution, social outcomes and data quality before comparing development.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. Output is R600 million and population 10 000. Find output per person.

2. Why can two places with equal GDP per capita have different living standards?

3. Name one limitation of comparing indicators from different years.

04 Check and correct

1. R60 000 per person.

2. Distribution, public services, costs and other conditions may differ.

3. Economic or demographic changes can make the figures non-comparable over time.

Common mistake to avoid

GDP per capita is not each person’s salary and does not prove that benefits are equally shared.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Development geography: indicators and development

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: Geography. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID geo-11.